JUN NAGAOKA

Lead / Senior 3D Artist · 3D Generalist · Technical Artist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead 3D Artist and Technical Artist with deep experience in AR/VR and real-time production, including animation, character rigging, modeling, lighting, rendering, and compositing. Builds and manages asset pipelines for real-time assets, provides technical support to artists, and collaborates closely with art directors and engineers. Career credits include commercial AR applications, VR storytelling, game cinematics, and exhibition work.

CORE SKILLS

- **3D Production:** Modeling, texturing, character animation, character rigging, lighting, rendering, previs
- **3D:** Autodesk Maya
- **Design & Compositing:** Adobe After Effects, Illustrator, Photoshop
- **AI-Assisted Development:** Claude, Cursor, ChatGPT, Grok Bot
- **Technical / Pipeline:** Asset and production pipeline development; technical support for artists
- **Leadership:** Lead artist and lead animator roles; supervising artists on animation, modeling, and texturing; collaboration with engineers and outsourcing partners
- **Languages:** English and Japanese (bilingual)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead 3D Artist | Tactic Studio, San Francisco | May 2016 – November 2026

- Splattic development: As an artist with no programming background, built this AR/VR/XR workflow web app using AI coding tools. Supports glTF, 3DGS, 4DGS, USD, and FBX; enables quick previews for directors and clients as AR/VR/XR experiences or HTML pages; and generates JSON and JavaScript files for engineering handoff.
- Lead 3D art production for branded AR applications.
- Selected projects: Coca-Cola Winter AR app; Jack Daniel's AR app; Jim Beam AR app; Treasury Wine Estates (19 Crimes, Cali by Snoop Dogg, Universal Monsters Halloween and other Living Wine Labels AR apps); many more AR and VR projects.

3D Generalist / TD | SPY POST, San Francisco | February 2016 – May 2016

- Automobile commercial project: animation, lighting, rendering, and compositing.

3D Generalist / TD | Swordfish, San Francisco | January 2016 – February 2016

- Commercial projects for HTC 10 smartphone and HTC Vive: animation, lighting, rendering, and compositing.

3D Generalist / TD | Evil Eye Pictures, San Francisco | February 2015 – December 2015

- Contributed to animated VR shorts for Google Spotlight Stories. Layout animation, scene setup, character rigging, modeling assets and environments; coordination with an outsourcing company on character models and rigging; technical support for artists and production needs.
- Contributed to Pearl (directed by Patrick Osborne), the first VR film nominated for an Academy Award, and an Emmy Award–winning animated 360-degree/VR short film; premiered on HTC Vive at the 2016 Tribeca Film Festival.
- On Ice (directed by Shannon Tindle): 3D production support on the Google Spotlight Stories slate.

Senior Artist | DeNA West, San Francisco | December 2014

- Blood Brothers 2 (mobile app): particle FX in Unity.
- Transformers: Age of Extinction (mobile app): character rigging and animation.

Senior Artist | Insight Digital, Emeryville, CA | October 2014 – November 2014

- Mission to the Deep — MBARI exhibition at Monterey Bay Aquarium: compositing in NUKE and After Effects, rotoscoping, 3D modeling and texturing.

Senior Artist | Ntropic, San Francisco | June 2014 – October 2014

- Lighting and rendering with V-Ray for commercial projects; VR and AR R&D in Unity. Selected work: modeling, lighting, and rendering for Apple Watch premiere presentation; lighting and rendering for Nest international commercial.

Senior Artist | DeNA West, San Francisco | January 2014 – June 2014

- Model review and fixes; character rigging and animation in Maya; created character asset integration pipeline with Unity. Projects included Transformers: Age of Extinction and Marvel Mighty Heroes.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Artist | SPY POST, San Francisco | June 2013 – August 2013

- Character rigger and animator for game cinematic (Sony PlayStation title undisclosed).

Lead Animator | Floathybrid Entertainment, San Francisco | 2010 – 2013

- Studio founded by Academy Award–winning VFX designer John Gaeta; early Microsoft Kinect incubation team member working with prototype Kinect products.
- Worked directly with the art director on previs animation for prototype Kinect games; collaborated with engineers to deliver models, textures, character rigs, and animation for Unity and Unreal.
- Created particle FX and shader materials in-engine; created and managed asset pipelines; assisted other artists.
- Projects: prototype Kinect games for Microsoft; Escape Plan (PlayStation Vita); G.E. Interactive "Hologram" exhibit; UI/UX visualization for iPad apps; technical previs for McDonald's, Pepsi, Amana, and others.

Senior Artist | Insight Digital, Emeryville | 2008 – 2010

- All-aspect production: modeling, texturing, animation, camera layout, and rendering; laser-scan / point cloud and image-based modeling; high-resolution photographic texturing; on-location laser scanning; data management and pipeline R&D.
- Projects: Trésors engloutis du Nil (French TV); Tales of Maya Skies (Chabot Space & Science Center); Ramesseum Panel (French government site displays); Avila Portal reassembly with 3D scan geometry (USF); projection-animation preproduction for the National Academy for the Performing Arts (Trinidad and Tobago).

Senior TD | Black Point Studios, San Francisco | 2005 – 2008

- Lead animator across CG production (modeling, texturing, character rigging, lighting, rendering, compositing); supervised artists on animation, modeling, and texturing; supervised motion capture sessions; managed production pipeline.
- Credits: Iron Man cinematics (Secret Level); Blacksite: Area 51 and Stranglehold (Midway); WWE SmackDown 2007/2008 (THQ); Eragon (Stormfront Studios); James Bond: From Russia with Love (EA); Gods and Heroes (Perpetual Entertainment).

Senior Artist | Mondo Media (Mondo Studios), San Francisco | 2003 – 2005

- Animator, lighting artist, compositor, and character rigger. Projects: James Bond: Everything or Nothing (EA) cinematics; Age of Empires III cinematics (Microsoft Ensemble Studios; AI.Implant).

Senior Artist | Robot of Mars, Berkeley | 2002 – 2003

- Animation, lighting, compositing, and character rigging for 3D ride film Robot of Mars.

EDUCATION

MFA, Computer Animation — Academy of Art College

BFA, Photography — Academy of Art College